

mtg-liquidity-signal: the Current Liquidity index

Snapshot 2026-08-28. By Cameraderie Cards. Informational only, not financial advice.

Every existing model in this toolkit tells you *direction*: will a card rise (buy), has it peaked (sell), is it about to be reprinted (brace). None of them tells you whether you can actually **exit**. A perfect sell call is worthless on a card that takes months to move and only at a deep discount. This model fills that gap. It assigns every Magic: The Gathering card a **Current Liquidity** score from 0 to 100: how easily an owner could turn it into cash right now.

What goes into the score

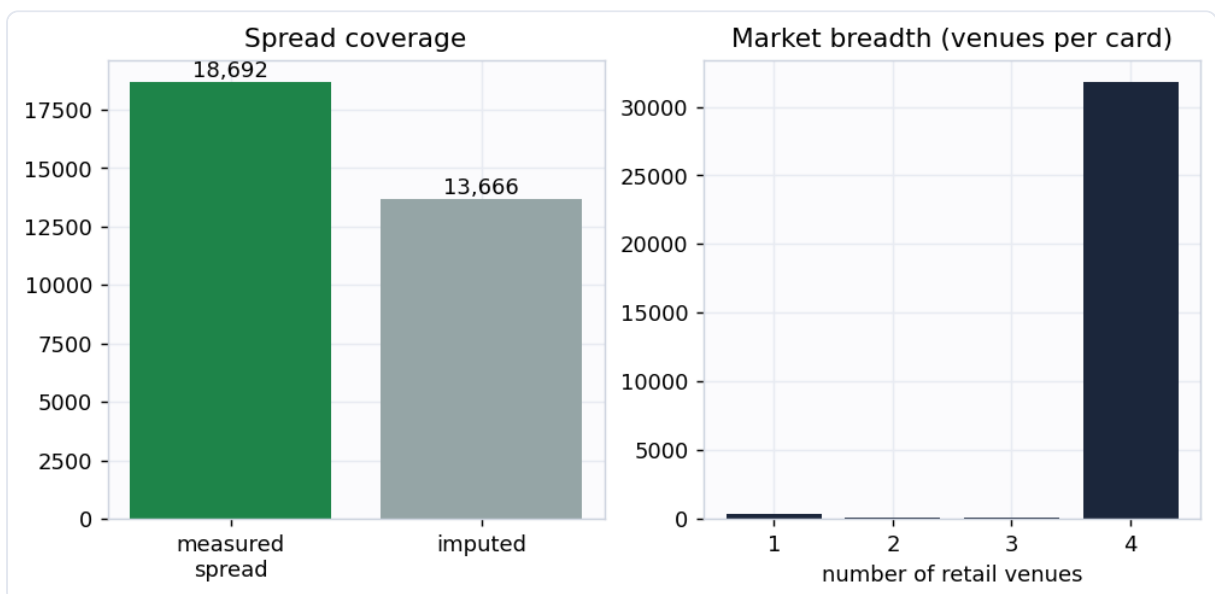
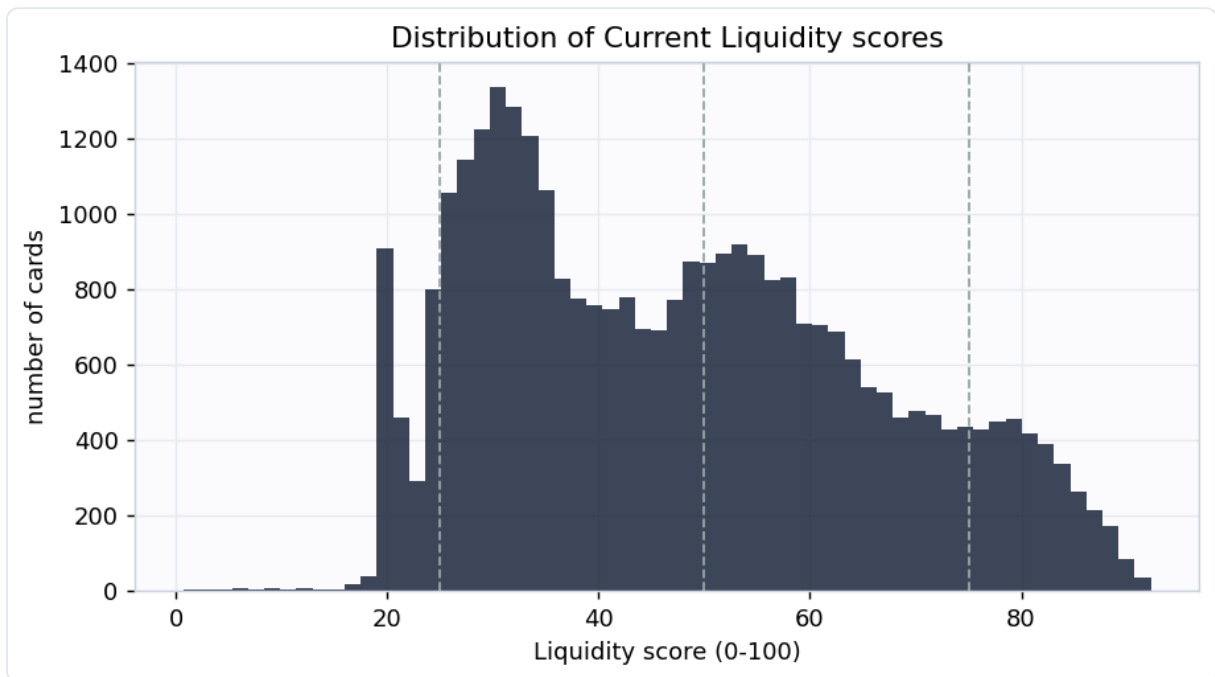
Liquidity is built from four measurable proxies, each normalized to a percentile and blended (weights {'spread': 0.4, 'depth': 0.25, 'activity': 0.2, 'demand': 0.15}):

Component	What it measures	Source
Spread	bid-ask cost to round-trip, CardKingdom buylist vs retail on the same printing	multi-venue price feed
Depth	how many venues list the card, whether a dealer will buy it, cross-venue price agreement	multi-venue price feed
Activity	how often the quoted price actually moves over 120 days (a flat price means nothing is trading)	16-year daily history
Demand	Commander-format popularity (EDHREC)	EDHREC

A card scores high only when it is cheap to exit, sold in many places, actively repricing, and wanted. The weights lean on the spread because that is the cost an owner actually pays to sell.

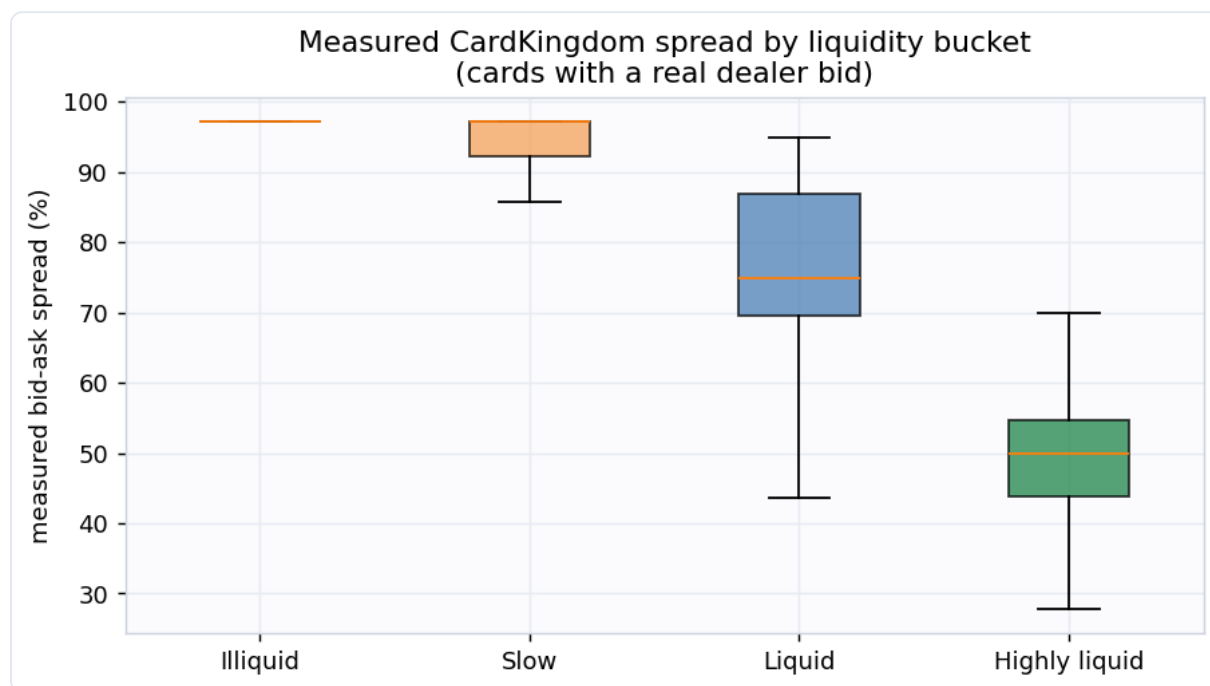
Coverage

Scored **32,358 cards** at this snapshot. **18,692** of them have a real dealer bid (CardKingdom buylist), so their spread is **measured**, not estimated; the median measured spread is **86.8%**. Cards without a dealer bid are flagged `is_imputed` and scored from depth, activity, and demand only.

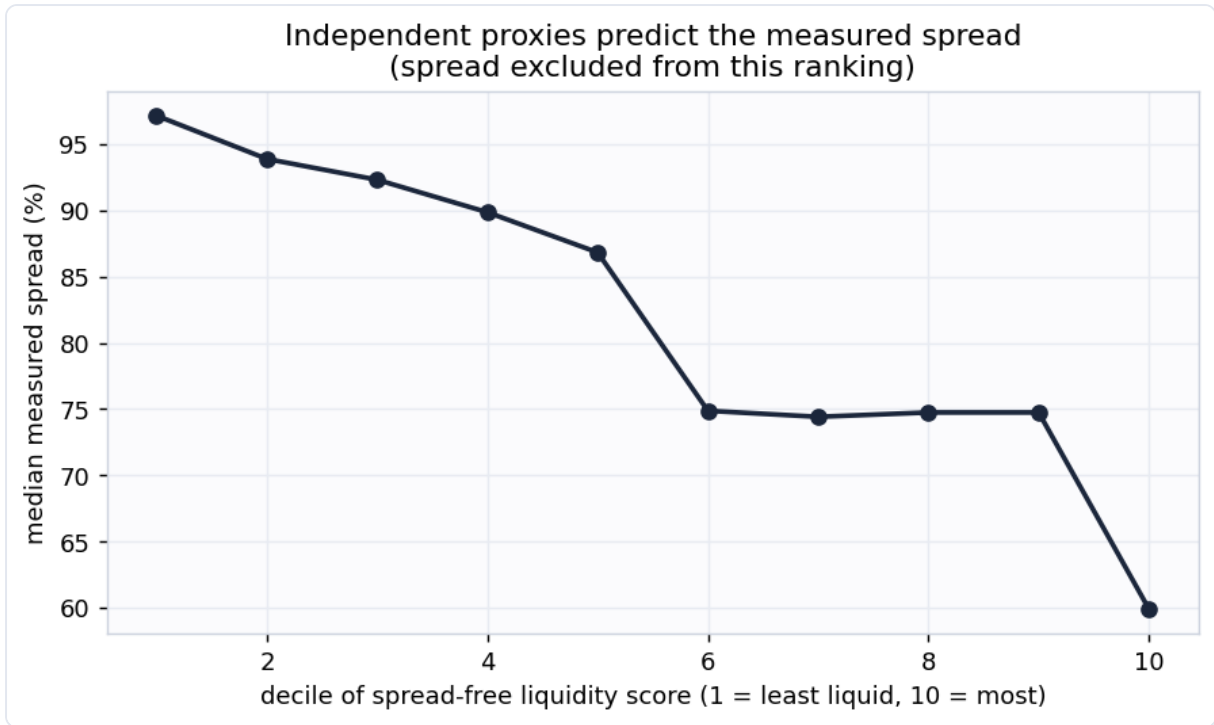


Does the score mean anything? Two honest checks

1. Measured spread lines up with the buckets. Cards the index calls illiquid really do cost more to round-trip. Because the spread is one input to the score, this is partly a consistency check rather than a clean test.



2. Independent proxies predict the spread (the real test). If we rank cards using *only* depth, activity, and demand and deliberately **exclude the spread**, the measured spread still falls steadily as that spread-free score rises (rank correlation **0.462**). The proxies that never saw the spread agree with the spread. That is genuine corroboration, not circular reasoning.



Example cards

Example cards (snapshot 2026-08-28)

	Sakura-Tribe Elder score 92 spread 37%	Cavern of Souls score 92 spread 35%	Phyrexian Arena score 92 spread 38%	Avenger of Zendikar score 92 spread 37%	Urza's Incubator score 92 spread 36%
Most liquid	Sakura-Tribe Elder Creature — Snake Shaman Sacrifice this creature: Search your library for a basic land card, put that card onto the battlefield tapped, then shuffle. He'll choose a sunlit clearing with open skies and an ample brook. All that remained was to find a worthy sapling. 1/1	Cavern of Souls Land As Cavern of Souls enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. • Add {0}. • Add one mana of any color. Spend this mana only to cast a creature spell of the chosen type, and that spell can't be countered.	Phyrexian Arena Enchantment At the beginning of your upkeep, you draw a card and you lose 1 life. A spark of resistance against a tide of corruption.	Avenger of Zendikar Creature — Elemental When this creature enters, create a 0/1 green Plant creature token for each land you control. Landfall — Whenever a land you control enters, you may put a +1/+1 counter on each Plant creature you control.	Urza's Incubator Artifact As Urza's Incubator enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. Creature spells of this chosen type cost 2 less to cast. "Our recruitment drives are bringing in fewer fresh troops every day. We need a new strategy." —Urza, to Tevesh
Least liquid (> \$5)	Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver Planeswalker — Bolas Each opponent loses 3 life unless that player sacrifices a nonland permanent or discards a card. • Destroy target creature. Draw a card. Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver deals 7 damage to each opponent. You draw seven cards. 3	Gandalf the White Legendary Creature — Avatar Wizard Flash You may cast legendary spells and artifact spells as though they had flash. If a legendary permanent or an artifact entering or leaving the battlefield causes a triggered ability of a permanent you control to trigger, that ability triggers an additional time. 4/5	Cavern-Hoard Dragon Creature — Dragon This spell costs 8 less to cast, where X is the greatest number of artifacts an opponent controls. Flying, trample, haste Whenever Cavern-Hoard Dragon deals combat damage to a player, you create a Treasure token for each artifact that player controls. 6/6	Bramblewood Paragon Creature — Elf Warrior Each other Warrior creature you control comes into play with an additional +1/+1 counter on it. Each creature you control with a +1/+1 counter on it has trample. Those who seek to escape her blades succeed only in dying on their stomachs. 2/2	Taolist Hermit Creature — Monk Whenever your opponent chooses a creature in play, he or she can't choose Taolist Hermit. "Taolist chose to be hermitic for many reasons, but all shared one unchanging goal: to follow the Tao." Illus. Wang Yuyang 2/12

The most liquid cards are heavily played eternal and Commander staples that sell in minutes at a known price. The least liquid expensive cards are thin-market oddities: no dealer will quote a buy price, and they list in only one or two places.

Buckets

Bucket	Score	Cards	Median measured spread
Highly liquid	75-100	3,386	49.9%
Liquid	50-75	10,889	74.9%
Slow	25-50	15,581	97.1%
Illiquid	0-25	2,502	97.1%

How this plugs into the other signals

Liquidity is a multiplier on every other call. It converts "should I sell" into "can I sell, how fast, at what cost," and it filters out illiquid buy candidates the spike model would otherwise flag. In the toolkit's risk-adjusted value equation, the expected value of a position is discounted by its spread and expected time-to-sale to get a **net realizable** value.

Honest limitations

- This is **version 1: a composite proxy index, not a supervised forecast**. It does not carry a held-out AUC because there is no public ground-truth label for "days to sale."
- There is **no true traded-volume or listing-count data yet**. Spread, price staleness, and venue breadth are stand-ins for depth and velocity. The roadmap adds TCGplayer listing counts and sales velocity (the printing table already carries the join key), which will replace the proxies with measured depth.
- Buylist coverage is CardKingdom-only and United States centric. Cards without a CardKingdom bid have an imputed spread and should be read with that caveat.
- Informational only, not financial advice.

Generated by `scripts/build_report.py` from `data/processed/liquidity_features.parquet`.